blitz. He was everywhere, on the radio, on television, and in the pages of prominent newspapers. He had refused to debate Isaac Herzog, the head of the Zionist Camp, fearing it would boost his challenger's profile, but Channel 2 managed to bring them together for a few minutes on Saturday night. Netanyahu had dark bags under his eyes, looking as if he hadn't slept in a week. "How are you?" asked the interviewer, Rima Matzliach. "I'm good. I'm more concerned with the well-being of the country," he replied, before he launched into his talking points.

Everywhere he went, the message was the same: right-wing governance, and therefore the state of Israel, was in danger. The *Jerusalem Post* asked Netanyahu if his loss at the polls could mean the country's destruction. He didn't contest the proposition.

On Sunday night, with thirty-six hours to go, tens of thousands of right-wing Israelis gathered for a rally in Tel Aviv's Rabin Square. A giant banner demanding the death penalty for terrorists loomed over the crowd. Supporters were taking photos next to cardboard cutouts of Naftali Bennett, the head of the religious-settler Jewish Home party. Bennett himself broke out a guitar and sang "Jerusalem of Gold". A group of young men taunted a woman watching from her balcony, where she had hung a poster for the liberal Meretz party, asking her to "Come down here and face us!" Someone handed out glow sticks. It had the atmosphere of some strange post-apocalyptic street fair.

Netanyahu was the keynote speaker, and he urged voters to "come home" to Likud from other conservative parties. "Our rivals are investing in a huge effort to harm me and the Likud, to open a gap between my party, the Likud, and our enemies, and if we don't close this gap, there is a real danger that a left-wing government will come to power," he warned.

The following day he toured Har Homa, a settlement in occupied East Jerusalem, and promised a major wave of new construction if re-elected. Then he disavowed the two-state solution, something he had publicly endorsed in a landmark 2009 speech at Bar-Ilan University. "If you are prime minister, you will not establish a Palestinian state?" asked an interviewer from NRG, a news site owned by Sheldon Adelson, the American casino mogul who is Netanyahu's main patron. "Indeed," the prime minister replied.

The coup de grace came around noon on election day. Netanyahu posted a video to his Facebook page, saying "Arab voters are coming out in droves